

PER PAULSEN

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Summary

Economic Market Designer (PhD summa cum laude, TUM; 4 A*/A-journal publications) turned AI Product Engineer. Built on 10+ years of making data-driven decisions across research, startups, and industry - including 20+ supervised machine learning theses with industry partners. Now building AI-native software products end-to-end and seeking senior roles in small, agile teams across product and AI engineering.

Skills

AI Product Engineering AI-Native Coding, Prompt & Context Engineering, LLM & RAG Integration, Agentic AI Systems & Orchestration, Product Strategy & Discovery, User Research, Roadmapping, Backlog Management

Machine Learning, Statistics & Data Science Deep Learning, Probabilistic Modeling, Forecasting, Causal Inference, A/B Testing, Experimental Design, Econometrics, Statistical Analysis, Business Analytics

Market & Mechanism Design Combinatorial Auctions, Auction Theory, Algorithmic Mechanism Design, Game Theory, Behavioral Game Theory, Industrial Organization, Economic Modeling

Portfolio

Expliq AI (MVP) | expliq-mvp.vercel.app | [code](#)

Automation intelligence platform for no/low-code automations (e.g. n8n). Stack: Claude Code, Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase (Postgres), Vercel, OpenRouter/Anthropic LLMs; prototyped in Lovable.

APIQ (MVP) | apiq-mvp.vercel.app | [code](#)

API Intelligence platform: LLM-mediated comprehension, scoring, and one-click improvement of OpenAPI specs. Rebooted from an Express/Node.js prototype. Stack: same as Expliq AI.

Reap (Prototype) | reap.zapier.app

Instant payout service for private sellers on second-hand platforms (e.g. Vinted). End-to-end product design. Stack: Figma, Zapier.

Retail Analysis (Showcase) | [live site](#) | [code](#)

End-to-end analytics: market basket, RFM, CLV, survival, forecasting, embeddings, causal uplift. Stack: R, Python.

Experience

AI Software Engineer | Digitale Leute School | 01/2026 – 04/2026 | school.digitale-leute.de/ai

- Built *Expliq AI* end-to-end as portfolio project, validated with first users on real n8n instances; live MVP.
- AI Software Engineering Bootcamp: Product Skills for Engineers, AI Software Engineering Foundations, Software Engineering with AI, Agentic AI Engineering; 100% attendance (1st of cohort).

Product Manager | Digitale Leute School | 01/2025 – 04/2025 | school.digitale-leute.de/pm

- Led *Reap* as portfolio project (live MVP), validated through 20 user interviews and 10 prototype testers.
- Product Management Bootcamp: Product Strategy & Discovery, Product & UX Design, Team & Backlog Management, Product Analytics & Testing.

Career Break | 01/2023 – 12/2024

- Health and well-being, while supporting family business restructuring. Re-engaged via DL School Bootcamps.

Product Engineer & Founder | Independent + UnternehmerTUM | 07/2021 – 12/2022

- GombaZ* (UnternehmerTUM): co-founded ML-powered service-orchestration platform; pitched to 5+ tech CEOs/CTOs and potential investors. Stack: Apache Airflow, Python, TensorFlow. [archive](#)
- Send-2-Session*: built and deployed no-code platform for composable apps via URL-chained third-party pages (Stripe, Mailchimp, Calendly). Stack: React, Firebase, Cloud Functions. [archive](#)
- APIQ*: built prototype for OpenAPI spec exploration; rebooted as AI-native MVP. Stack: Express/Node.js.

Doctoral Researcher & Consultant | TUM Graduate School | 08/2017 – 06/2021 | gs.tum.de

- Consulted on procurement auction design for Kuka and Robert Bosch, delivering six-figure absolute and double-digit % cost savings.
- Built smart-contract of a four-stage procurement auction on the blockchain. Stack: Solidity. [archive](#)
- Published 4 A*/A-journal papers on auction and mechanism design.
- Completed PhD dissertation summa cum laude on multi-unit package auctions.

Research Associate | TU Munich, Computer Science | 06/2012 – 07/2017 | cs.cit.tum.de/dss

- Supervised 20 ML theses with industry partners (BMW, Allianz, Capgemini, Celonis, Telefónica, AutoScout24, treefin), e.g. insurance payment classification at treefin and semiconductor failure prediction at BMW.
- Coordinated the master's module Business Analytics and led tutorials in Auction Theory & Market Design.
- Contributed to DFG-funded research project "New Trends in Revenue Management" and Robert Bosch research cooperation on procurement auctions.

Student Assistant (first hire) | LMU Munich, MELESSA | 03/2008 – 08/2011 | melessa.uni-muenchen.de

- Co-built lab from scratch; implemented decision experiments (z-Tree, R) with thousands of participants.

Education

PhD (Dr. oec. publ., summa cum laude) | TU Munich | 2015 – 2019 | [Dissertation](#)

Coursework: Advanced Econometrics, Behavioral Game Theory, Experimental Economics, Causal Inference.

M.A. Economics (Ranked 1st) | LMU Munich | 2009 – 2012 | [LMU Econ](#)

Focus: Auction theory, market design, econometrics.

Graduate Exchange | University of Wisconsin-Madison | 2009 – 2010 | [Wisconsin Econ](#)

Focus: Microeconomics, econometrics, macroeconomics.

B.A. Economics (Ranked 3rd) | LMU Munich | 2006 – 2009

Focus: Microeconomics (auction theory), econometrics, behavioral economics.

Honors & Awards

- **Summa cum laude** (PhD, TU Munich, 2019).
- **Best Theory Development Paper Nomination** (ICIS 2016).
- **Alumni-Preis für junge Volkswirte** (LMU Munich, 2012). Best overall achievement in the master's program. [Alumni-Preis](#)
- **Madison Program Scholarship** (Kurt Fordan Foundation, 2009). Sole recipient that year, competitive selection.
- **ECONNECT** (LMU Munich, 2009). One-year industry mentorship for top 15% students (e.g. BCG, Deutsche Bundesbank, PwC), competitive selection. [ECONNECT](#)

Selected Publications

- *The beauty of Dutch: Bidding behavior in combinatorial first-price procurement auctions* (European Journal of Operational Research, 2021). [DOI](#)
- *The beauty of Dutch: Ex-post split-award auctions in procurement markets with diseconomies of scale* (European Journal of Operational Research, 2019). [DOI](#)
- *First-Price Split-Award Auctions in Procurement Markets with Economies of Scale: An Experimental Study* (Production and Operations Management, 2019). [DOI](#)
- *A principal-agent model of bidding firms in multi-unit auctions* (Games and Economic Behavior, 2018). [DOI](#)

Engagement

Co-Founder | Netzwerk Engagement | 2016 – present | netzwerk-engagement.org

Awarding up to 10 scholarships annually to outstanding students with entrepreneurial commitment.